

LARA CROFT TOMB RAIDER LEGEND

Lara's in Good Hands now

After the terrifying downturn that Lara Croft's career took post-*Tomb Raider 3* (some would even say 2), it hardly seemed likely that the lady would rise from the grave that developer Core Studios had been so diligently digging for her. Now in the seemingly able hands of new developers Crystal Dynamics (the guys behind the *Legacy of Kain* series), the *Tomb Raider* franchise has been revamped and reintroduced to the masses.

To Thine Own Self Be True

The heart of any *Tomb Raider* game lies in exploring large environments, solving puzzles, leaping wantonly from ledge to rope to who-knows-what and a little shooting up of the bad guys. And, of course, watching Lara Croft carry out aforementioned activities. Lara's latest adventure will take her from the jungles of South America to the

icy corners of the Himalayas and the streets of England, among other locations, on a quest to find out the truth about King Arthur's Excalibur, an ex-colleague who didn't really die and what really caused her mother's death. She's not alone, though, and will constantly find herself in the middle of skirmishes with the enemy.

The game's environments—open spaces and dungeons alike—are mind-bogglingly large at times, and nearly always breathtaking. We often left Lara hanging on to a cliff while we took a look-see at the entire set before proceeding. You will also encounter puzzles ranging in difficulty and complexity from the simple push-this-do-that type to the insanely elaborate push-this-pull-that-shimmy-down-wall-DON'T-DIE-shoot-this-and-then-s-wiiiiing kind—you get the drift.

Throughout the game, you'll also be treated to some interactive cutscenes—press the arrows that the game tells you to in time. Miss a cue, and Lara will